ENGLISH I · WEEK 1

The vowel sounds IITM asks about

Sounds are a big part of English I. Learn the course's way of writing them.

LONG VOWELS

Written as double letters

ii

seat, meet, wheat

aa

car, hard

oo

law, court, board

uu

food, root, loot

əə

bird

Short u is the vowel in foot.

TRAPS

Spelling lies

⚠ 'oo' in foot is short u. In food and root it is long uu.

⚠ The course's oo is the vowel in law and court, not the one in food.

⚠ a/an go by sound, not letter: an hour, an MBA, a university.

PYQ ANSWERS (2023–24)

Pick the word

Has the 'u' sound: Root / Foot / Court

Foot

Has the 'oo' sound: Court / Loot / Cat / Feat

Court

Has the 'aa' sound: Hoard / Board / Hard / Teeth

Hard

Has no 'ii' sound: Meet / Lead / Wet / Wheat

Wet

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